

The tone of the NBP Governor's press conference was broadly in line with our forecast, assuming the next hike in first quarter 2027. He recognised rising inflation risks linked to geopolitical tensions and solid domestic demand. There are concerns of higher energy prices feeding into the economy. The central bank appears willing to wait to raise rates

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During his October press conference, National Bank of Poland (NBP) Governor Adam Glapiński highlighted growing risks to the inflation outlook. At the same time, however, he stressed that the rise in prices so far has been driven by an external supply shock and that there is little evidence of higher energy costs spreading broadly to the prices of other goods and services.

Global sources of inflation

Explaining the rationale behind the October decision to leave interest rates unchanged, NBP Governor Adam Glapiński stressed that the global economy is facing an energy shock resulting from the conflict in the Middle East. The conflict is becoming more protracted, and its inflationary effects are intensifying. Polish inflation rose above the upper bound of the NBP's tolerance band around its target in September (2.5%; +/-1 percentage point), but it should return to that range in October.

Local inflationary factors are in play

In the governor's view, the inflation outlook is subject to greater

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He therefore reiterated that the main Monetary Policy Council (MPC) objective is to prevent higher fuel prices from spilling over into other prices across the economy.

Inflation still primarily driven by a supply shock, no second-round effects

Balancing the risks outlined above, the MPC chairman also emphasised that almost all the increase in inflation to date has resulted from higher fuel prices. In September, energy accounted for 60% of inflation, while the pass-through from energy prices to

other prices has remained limited. The increase in core inflation excluding food and energy since the beginning of the year has been modest, and core inflation probably edged down slightly in September. There are also currently no signs of second-round effects.

Monetary policy guidance

Future central bank decisions will depend on incoming data and the shape of the November macroeconomic projection. Governor Glapiński does not currently see a need for an interest rate increase at the next meeting in November, although he did not rule one out

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We see a risk of a modest increase in core inflation around the turn of 2026-27, which in our view would warrant a precautionary rise in interest rates.

Poland interest rates

Poland interest rate decision

National bank of poland press conference

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